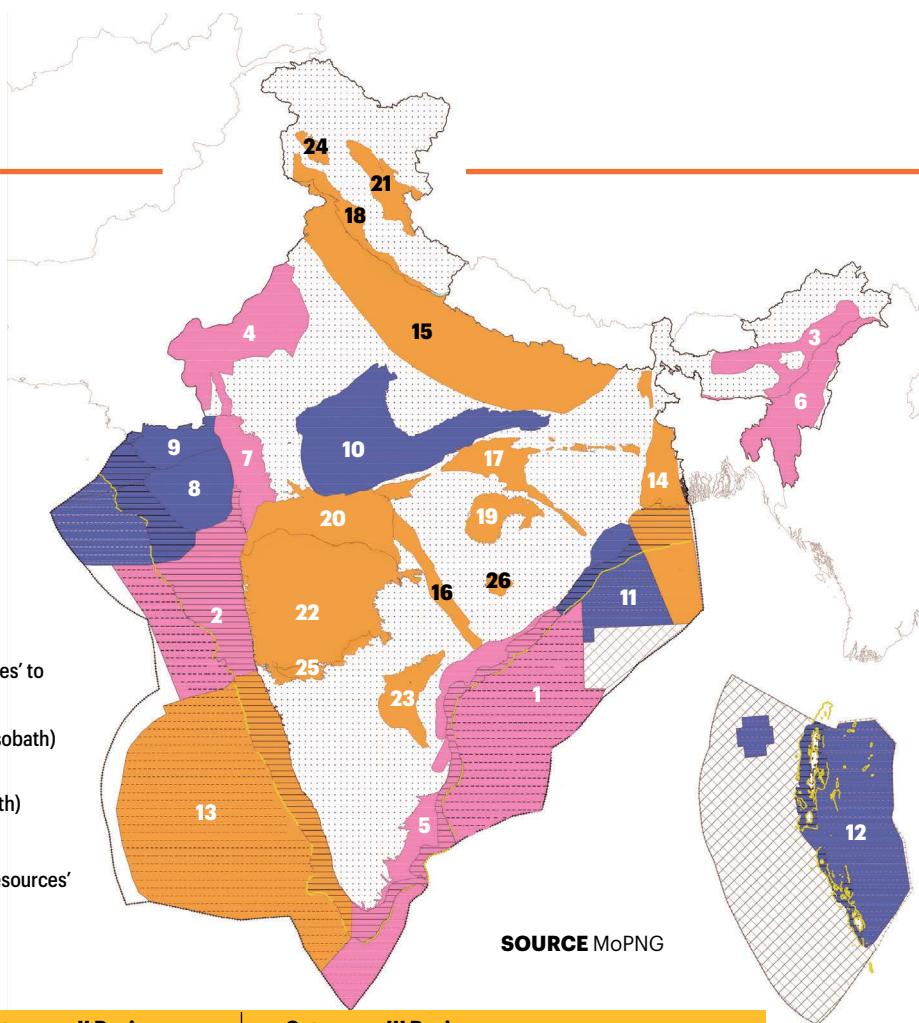
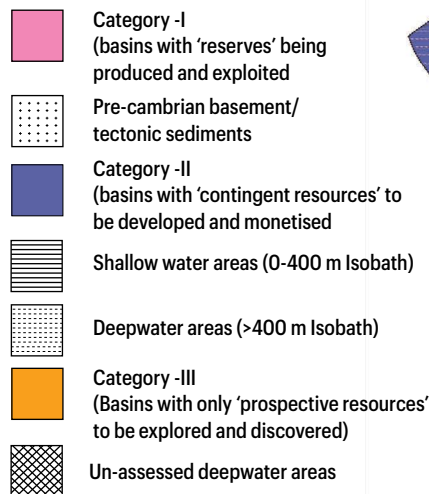


INDIAN SEDIMENTARY BASIN

Only 30% of the area is under commercial production



SOURCE MoPNG

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Category -I Basins	Category -II Basins	Category -III Basins	
01. Krishna-Godavari	08. Saurashtra	13. Kerala-Konkan	20. Narmada
02. Mumbai Offshore	09. Kutch	14. Bengal-Purnea	21. Spiti-Zaskar
03. Assam-Shelf	10. Vindhyan	15. Ganga-Punjab	22. Deccan Syneclise
04. Rajasthan	11. Mahanadi	16. Pranhita-Godavari	23. Cuddapah
05. Cauvery	12. Andaman	17. Satpura-South Rewa-Damodar	24. Karewa
06. Assam-Arakan Fold Belt		18. Himalayan Foreland	25. Bhima-Kaladgi
07. Cambay		19. Chhattisgarh	26. Bastar

carried out by private companies such as Assam Oil Ltd, Oil India Ltd (then, a 50:50 JV between the government and Burmah Oil Company) and Indo-Stanvac (owned by the government and Standard Vacuum Oil of the US). Then came the nationalisation wave of the 1970s that saw the creation of giant oil PSUs, followed by India's biggest hydrocarbon discovery to date, Bombay High (in 1974) which, at its peak in the late '80s, accounted for 68% of India's crude oil production. There has been no big oil discovery since then.

After the 1991 reforms, the government realised the need to attract private

capital into the country's oil & gas sector. A series of decisions led to the New Licensing and Exploration Policy (NELP) in the later part of the decade. One of its notable successes was the Krishna Godavari-D6 block. In 2000, the government awarded India's first major deepwater gas project to a consortium led by Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) that also included BP and Canada's Niko Resources. But the excitement was overshadowed by bitter litigation. First, the government disallowed a part of the costs incurred by RIL on developing the field and claimed an additional \$247 million as its share of profits. Then, state-

88%
INDIA'S
DEPENDENCE
ON IMPORTS
FOR CRUDE OIL,
UP FROM 65% IN
THE 1980s